

# PSYCHOLOGY OF LANGUAGE (LING/PHIL/PSY 432)

**INSTRUCTOR:** Asma  
**Email:** asma1@arizona.edu

**OFFICE HOURS:** FLEXIBLE (Available by Appointment)

## D2L COURSE WEBSITE

The syllabus, readings, and all relevant assignments and quizzes will be posted on d2l, as will weekly announcements and other important information. You must have regular and reliable access to our website in order to participate fully in this class. Please make a point of checking the website daily. One quick check may save you time in other ways!

## READINGS

Readings for this course (subject to change) are provided, free of charge, on d2l.

## COURSE DESCRIPTION, OBJECTIVES & OUTCOMES

This course is an upper division linguistics course typically taken by juniors and seniors. It is an elective for students in Linguistics, Philosophy, and Psychology. In this class, we will explore the discipline of psycholinguistics, which is a branch of cognitive science. A thorough understanding requires a marriage of basic linguistic facts and psychological theory (i.e., you need to know what the basic components of language are as well as how those components are stored in, and retrieved from, your mind). The fundamental question to be answered is how language is processed by speakers and listeners. As humans, most of our waking hours are spent engaged in this activity. Think about how many times a day you are speaking, listening, reading, and writing. Then think about how you are interpreting the words you are now reading, or hearing, or forming questions you might be about to ask. Chances are that you have no idea how this is done. It just “comes out” or you just “get it”. But how? In this course, we will explore how you achieve these things with little to no perceivable effort while also being largely unaware of the process. Accordingly, topics to be covered typically include the nature of language, speech perception, word recognition, sentence comprehension and production, the process of reading and writing, processing in a compromised system, and language acquisition.

Among other things, students in this course will learn how to:

- Identify and summarize the individual as well as the overlapping tasks of the language processing system.
- Assess and discuss scholarly work and key issues related to language processing.
- Compare and/or replicate the results of various methodologies used to investigate psycholinguistic phenomena.
- Demonstrate knowledge and understanding of investigations of language processing in written reports.

## COURSE REQUIREMENTS AND GRADING

| <u>TASKS</u>                  | <u>TOTAL POINTS</u>                  | <u>SCALE</u> |
|-------------------------------|--------------------------------------|--------------|
| Problem Sets (5 in total)     | 16 points each x 5 sets = 80 points  | 90% = A      |
| Discussion Posts (2 in total) | 10 points each x 2 posts = 20 points | 80% = B      |
| <b>TOTAL POSSIBLE POINTS</b>  | 100                                  | 70% = C      |
|                               |                                      | 60% = D      |
|                               |                                      | <60% = E     |

## DESCRIPTION OF ASSIGNMENTS

**Problem Sets:** To pass this course, you are required to complete weekly problem sets which account for 80% of the final grade. These problem sets function as assignments. You will submit these problem sets in the form of a quiz on d2l. All quizzes will be administered through D2L and will consist of objective-style questions, including true/false, multiple choice, matching, and multi-select questions.

**Discussion Posts:** Discussion posts account for 20% of the final course grade. These activities are designed to help you develop skills in locating, reading, evaluating, and discussing scholarly research in psychology of language. Through weekly engagement with the research literature, you will gain a deeper understanding of course concepts while learning how psycholinguistic knowledge is generated through empirical investigation.

### SCHEDULE A MEETING WITH THE INSTRUCTOR

If you want to schedule a meeting, you should go to this link:

[https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1fnfim-fODgmzDeKcl0XDAuVwJhq\\_KLH9JtY8kbq92e8/edit?usp=sharing](https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1fnfim-fODgmzDeKcl0XDAuVwJhq_KLH9JtY8kbq92e8/edit?usp=sharing)

Write your name in the available and most suitable time slot. Also, in brackets, write (zoom) for zoom meetings or (in-person) for in-person meetings. Also, send me an email informing me about it, just in case Google does not let me know automatically when you add your name. For zoom meetings, I usually send the link 5 minutes before the meeting.

### SCHEDULE (SUBJECT TO CHANGE)

| WEEK | DATE   | TOPIC                                                                   | TASKS DUE DATE                   |
|------|--------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| 1    | 6/8    | Introduction to Psycholinguistics: Language, Mind, and Research Methods |                                  |
|      | Sunday |                                                                         | ProblemSet 1                     |
| 2    | 6/15   | Speech Perception, the Brain, and Spoken Language Processing            |                                  |
|      | Sunday |                                                                         | ProblemSet 2                     |
| 3    | 6/22   | Words, Meaning, and the Mental Lexicon                                  |                                  |
|      | Sunday |                                                                         | ProblemSet 3 + Discussion Post 1 |
| 4    | 6/29   | Sentence Processing, Language Production, and Conversation              |                                  |
|      | Sunday |                                                                         | ProblemSet 4                     |
| 5    | 7/6    | Language Acquisition, Bilingualism, Language Disorders, and AI          |                                  |
|      | Sunday |                                                                         | ProblemSet 5 + Discussion Post 2 |

### FURTHER EXPECTATIONS

**Course Policies:** Students are expected to abide by all university policies regarding attendance, academic integrity, and codes of conduct. For details, please see: <https://academicaffairs.arizona.edu/syllabus-policies>.

**Late Policy.** Each student is expected to complete all assignments (exercises, exams, discussions) by the posted due dates. It is your responsibility to note when assignments are due and to submit them at the appropriate time in the appropriate format and via the appropriate venue. Assignments will close by the date/time indicated on d2l. Remember, the dates/times listed are “end dates”, NOT “start dates” (especially relevant for quizzes and exams). For all assignments, you have multiple days to complete them and a missed due date due to poor planning does not comprise a valid excuse for accommodation. Assignments and quizzes will not be accepted late and/or cannot be made up except under circumstances already recognized by UA Policy (see “Course Policies” above). If you miss coursework for any other reason, you will lose all points for that assignment unless prior arrangements have been made.

**Technical Issues.** If you have questions or concerns about d2l, there are university resources available to help you. If you experience a technical problem that is beyond your control (system shut-downs, network interruptions, etc.), please

notify us as soon as possible via email and submit a problem to the d2l team as promptly as possible (<http://help.d2l.arizona.edu>, click on “Report a Problem”).

**Course Notes.** Students should be aware that course lectures and slides, and any other associated materials are copyrighted to me and/or your textbook authors. This includes student notes or summaries that substantially reflect our lectures or materials. These materials are made available only for personal use by students, and students may not distribute or reproduce the materials for commercial purposes without our express written consent. Violation of our copyright violates the Code of Academic Integrity and may result in course sanctions.

**Performance.** Although students are expected to participate fully in this class and to complete all assignments on time, these achievements alone are not sufficient to pass this course. To pass this course, you *must* demonstrate that you have mastered the course concepts presented this term. Students who wish to earn an ‘A’ must demonstrate superior mastery of course concepts throughout their work this semester.

## **ADDITIONAL INFORMATION**

### **Absence & Class Participation**

The UA’s policies concerning Class Attendance and Participation is available at:  
<https://catalog.arizona.edu/policy/courses-credit/courses/class-attendance-participation>.

The UA policy regarding absences for any sincerely held religious belief, observance or practice will be accommodated where reasonable, <http://policy.arizona.edu/human-resources/religious-accommodation-policy>. The calendar of religious holidays can be found at <https://registrar.arizona.edu/calendar-religious-holidays>.

Absences for groups of more than three students that are pre-approved by the UA Dean of Students (or Dean Designee) will be honored. See: <http://policy.arizona.edu/employmenthuman-resources/attendance>.

### **Threatening Behavior Policy**

The UA Threatening Behavior by Students Policy prohibits threats of physical harm to any member of the University community, including to oneself. See <http://policy.arizona.edu/education-and-student-affairs/threatening-behavior-students>.

### **Accessibility & Accommodations**

At the University of Arizona, we strive to make learning experiences as accessible as possible. If you anticipate or experience barriers based on disability or pregnancy, please contact the Disability Resource Center (520-621-3268, <https://drc.arizona.edu/>) to establish reasonable accommodations.

See <http://drc.arizona.edu/instructors/syllabus-statement>.

### **Code of Academic Integrity**

Students are encouraged to share intellectual views and discuss freely the principles and applications of course materials. However, graded work/exercises must be the product of independent effort unless otherwise instructed. Students are expected to adhere to the UA Code of Academic Integrity as described in the UA General Catalog. See: <https://deanofstudents.arizona.edu/policies/code-academic-integrity>.

### **Nondiscrimination & Anti-Harassment**

The University of Arizona is committed to creating and maintaining an environment free of discrimination. In support of this commitment, the University prohibits discrimination, including harassment and retaliation, based on a protected classification, including race, color, religion, sex, national origin, age, disability, veteran status, sexual orientation, gender identity, or genetic information. For more information, including how to report a concern, please see <http://policy.arizona.edu/human-resources/nondiscrimination-and-anti-harassment-policy>.

### **Safety on Campus & in the Classroom**

For a list of emergency procedures for all types of incidents, please visit the website of the Critical Incident Response Team (CIRT): <https://cirt.arizona.edu/case-emergency/overview>.

Also watch the video available at [https://arizona.sabacloud.com/Saba/Web\\_spf/NA7P1PRD161/common/learningeventdetail/crtfy000000000003560](https://arizona.sabacloud.com/Saba/Web_spf/NA7P1PRD161/common/learningeventdetail/crtfy000000000003560).

### **Subject to Change Statement**

Information contained in the course syllabus, other than the grade and absence policy, may be subject to change with advance notice, as deemed appropriate by the instructor; see <http://policy.arizona.edu/faculty-affairs-and-academics/course-syllabus-policy-undergraduate-template>.

\*For co-convened 400/500-level classes, the instructor may use a single syllabus for the jointly convened class or separate syllabi for the graduate and undergraduate offerings. If a single syllabus is used, it must meet the requirements of both the Undergraduate and Graduate Syllabus Policies and must clearly distinguish between graduate and undergraduate requirements and workload expectations.

The following text is not required to be included on syllabi, but faculty are highly encouraged to include it to increase awareness of the important resources and safety information it describes.

### **Campus Pantry**

Any student who has difficulty affording groceries or accessing sufficient food to eat every day, or who lacks a safe and stable place to live and believes this may affect their performance in the course, is urged to contact the Dean of Students for support. In addition, the University of Arizona Campus Pantry is open for students to receive supplemental groceries at no cost. Please see their website at: [campuspantry.arizona.edu](http://campuspantry.arizona.edu) for open times.

### **Additional Resources for Students**

UA Academic policies and procedures are available at <https://catalog.arizona.edu/policy/all>.

### **Campus Health**

<http://www.health.arizona.edu/>

Campus Health provides quality medical and mental health care services through virtual and in-person care.

Phone: 520-621-9202

### **Counseling and Psych Services (CAPS)**

<https://health.arizona.edu/counseling-psych-services>

CAPS provides mental health care, including short-term counseling services.

Phone: 520-621-3334

### **The Dean of Students Office's Student Assistance Program**

<https://deanofstudents.arizona.edu/support/student-assistance>

Student Assistance helps students manage crises, life traumas, and other barriers that impede success. The staff addresses the needs of students who experience issues related to social adjustment, academic challenges, psychological health, physical health, victimization, and relationship issues, through a variety of interventions, referrals, and follow up services.

Email: [DOS-deanofstudents@arizona.edu](mailto:DOS-deanofstudents@arizona.edu)

Phone: 520-621-7057

### **Survivor Advocacy Program**

<https://survivoradvocacy.arizona.edu/>

The Survivor Advocacy Program provides confidential support and advocacy services to student survivors of sexual and gender-based violence. The Program can also advise students about relevant non-UA resources available within the local community for support.

Email: [survivoradvocacy@arizona.edu](mailto:survivoradvocacy@arizona.edu)

Phone: 520-621-5767

### **Preferred Name & Pronoun**

This course affirms people of all gender expressions and gender identities. If you prefer to be called a different name than what is on the class roster, please let me know. Feel free to correct instructors on your preferred gender pronoun. If you have any questions or concerns, please do not hesitate to contact me directly in class or via email (instructor email). If you wish to change your preferred name or pronoun in the UAccess system, please use the following guidelines:

**Preferred name:** University of Arizona students may choose to identify themselves within the University community using a preferred first name that differs from their official/legal name. A student's preferred name will appear instead of the person's official/legal first name in select University-related systems and documents, provided that the name is not being used for the purpose of misrepresentation. Students are able to update their preferred names in UAccess.

**Pronouns:** Students may designate pronouns they use to identify themselves. Instructors and staff are encouraged to use pronouns for people that they use for themselves as a sign of respect and inclusion. Students are able to update and edit their pronouns in UAccess.

More information on updating your preferred name and pronouns is available on the Office of the Registrar site at <https://www.registrar.arizona.edu/records-enrollment/personal-information/updating-personal-information>.

**Diversity & Inclusion.** Inclusive Excellence is a fundamental part of the University of Arizona's strategic plan and culture. As part of this initiative, the institution embraces and practices diversity and inclusiveness. These values are expected, respected and welcomed here. This course supports elective gender pronoun use and self-identification; any public rosters or names indicating such choices will be updated throughout the semester, upon student request. As the course includes peer discussions, it is vitally important for us to create an educational environment of inclusion and mutual respect.

**Students Facing Exceptional Circumstances.** If exceptional circumstances arise or are anticipated during the term, such as chronic illness, trauma, or an emergency with unforeseen and long-term impacts, please see the notices above regarding basic needs and accessibility and accommodations. You may also contact the [Dean of Students](#) office (520-621-7057), which provides support, and connections to appropriate services, for students. The Dean of Students can also act as a liaison for you with your professors and supervisors. The Dean of Students Office is located in the Robert L. Nugent Building, Room 100. If accommodation in this course is needed due to exceptional circumstances, official recognition of your situation must be provided in order to negotiate any change of schedule for any course components.

**Adding After the 1st Day of Class.** Provided you register within the appropriate time-frame and/or have instructor approval, you are welcome to join the course late. However, please be aware that you may have missed assignments and deadlines that your teaching team is *not* obligated to adjust. While adding after the first day will not prevent you from earning an excellent grade, it is not valid to assume that you can add late without incurring possible costs – regardless of the reason for your late admission to the course. You are responsible for learning about the material you missed because you added the class late, and you are responsible for working through the remaining items in the course calendar in order to earn the grade you hope to achieve this semester.

**Material Offensive to Some.** Some of the course material will consider the genetic and biological underpinnings of language.